



State-of-the-art facility: A cutting-edge indoor cricket academy in Raipur offers players a world-class training environment designed to elevate their game to the next level. MAYANK

THE BARABANKI SENSATION AND TAPPING INTO THE NEXT GENERATION

Our correspondents bring you the highlights and **intriguing moments**, both on and off the field, from the opening round of Ranji Trophy fixtures.

Mayank and Anish Pathiyil
mayank.c@thehindu.co.in,
anish.p@thehindu.co.in

When a 14-year-old girl at the Under-15 selection trials at the Chhattisgarh State Cricket Sangh (CSCS) Indoor Cricket Academy in the heart of Raipur brings to mind Paul Adams and his “frog in a blender” bowling

action, you can’t help but acknowledge the depth of cricketing talent in the state.

Her run-up starts like that of a typical spinner — short and slow. But as she reaches the crease, she contorts her body dramatically, releasing the ball from the back of her hand with her head tilted upwards, much like Karnataka’s Shivil Kaushik, whose claim to fame came in

the Indian Premier League in 2016. Chhattisgarh is home to many other promising talents, as the state steadily establishes itself on the cricketing map.

The Shaheed Veer Narayan Singh International Cricket Stadium, Raipur’s cricketing hub, has a story of its own. With a capacity of 65,000, it’s a colossal venue that leaves spectators in awe of its size.